

PM Tool Launch

Phased rollout, MVP-surface gating, full 5-tier access model, existing portal seed.

AUTHOR

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AUDIENCE

Leadership and the dev

HOW TO USE

Work top to bottom. Each section gates the next. Tick boxes as items ship. The cohort gates (sections 04, 05, 06) are explicit go/no-go decisions.

The four choices that shape this plan

Before writing this checklist, four launch-defining choices were made. The rest of the plan flows from them.

Launch shape	Phased by team / role. Three cohorts, each with a feedback window before the next wave starts.
QA bar	MVP surfaces only gate the launch. Home, Clients, Kanban, and Account Settings Profile / Members / Sign-in must close their HIGH findings before their cohort launches. Templates, Ops, Analytics, and the remaining Account Settings sub-pages can ship rougher with documented caveats.
Access model	Full 5-tier RBAC must ship for launch. Owner, Admin, Manager, Member, Viewer with the permission matrix and client scoping per the dev spec (docs/user-hierarchy-dev-spec.pdf).
Data state	Use the existing portal seed (142 clients already there). Verify a sample for accuracy before launch; backfill industry, account manager, and clean service names where missing.

WHY THESE FOUR

Launch shape sets the risk tolerance. QA bar sets the dev scope. Access model sets the build complexity. Data state sets the manual setup cost. Together they cover the four biggest sources of launch-day risk; everything else in this checklist is downstream of these four.

Prerequisites that block every cohort

None of the cohorts can launch until the access layer is in and the portal seed is verified. These two pieces are the long pole.

Access layer (RBAC)

- Implement *utils/access.ts* per the dev spec (AccessRole union, Action union, PERMISSIONS const, can() helper).
- Implement *utils/scope.ts* (canSeeClient, canSeeCard, canSeeMember).
- Wire **Layer A route guards** on Templates, Ops, Analytics, every Account Settings sub-page.
- Wire **Layer B component gates** on every action button (Create client, Archive, Delete, Edit, Transfer ownership).
- Wire **Layer C server-side rules** using the *actorRole(workspaceId)* helper. If using Firestore, ship the rule fragments from Section 07C of the dev spec.
- Add Cloud Function (or equivalent) trigger to keep *Workspace.memberRoles* in sync with *User.tier* writes.
- Run the seed migration script: set *Workspace.ownerId* to Nikko; map legacy Operations Manager -> Admin, Account Manager -> Manager, Operator -> Member; backfill *jobTitleId* from legacy labels.
- Run the per-tier acceptance walkthrough (Section 10 of the dev spec) on staging. All five tiers must be green.

Portal seed verification

- Sample 10 random clients from the 142-row seed. Confirm name, industry, account manager, services are accurate.
- Backfill **industry subtitle** on every row (Clients R5 finding flagged ~90% are blank). Either populate manually or set a sensible default like "Service".
- Clean service pill names: strip the "[Client] - [Service] - [ID]" legacy format down to [Service] only (Clients R5 MED finding).
- Confirm **Acme Corp test client** stays on portal as the demo / training reference (preserved through the migration).
- Snapshot the database BEFORE launch in case rollback is needed. Store snapshot off-host.

Infrastructure + ops

- Confirm production URL (dev.portal.121group.io stays for dev; pick the prod hostname, set up DNS + SSL).
- Set up error monitoring (Sentry or equivalent). Cap noisy warnings; alert only on uncaught errors.
- Set up basic uptime monitoring (Pingdom / UptimeRobot / etc.). Alert if the page 5xx's for 5 minutes.
- Set up auth provider for user invites (Google SSO is the fastest path; magic-link is an alternative).
- Set up email infrastructure for invite emails and (eventually) notification emails. Transactional provider like Resend or Postmark.
- Document the support channel where users log issues (private Slack channel or shared inbox).

DEFINITION OF DONE FOR FOUNDATION

Every box ticked, the per-tier acceptance walkthrough green on staging, the seed sample verified, and the database snapshot stored. Foundation done is the gate to Section 03.

Close the QA findings the team will actually hit

MVP surfaces are the pages the team will use day one. Close their HIGH findings before any cohort launches. Triage MED findings into must-fix and can-wait subsets. LOW findings stay open as backlog with no launch gate.

MVP surfaces (gate on these)

- **Home page:** 4 findings open from R5 (0 HIGH, 2 MED, 2 LOW). Close MEDs. LOWs to backlog.
- **Clients page:** 20 findings open from R5 (4 HIGH, 10 MED, 6 LOW). Close all 4 HIGHs. Triage MEDs.
- **Kanban board:** 18 findings open from R1 (4 HIGH, 8 MED, 6 LOW). Close all 4 HIGHs (especially breadcrumb literal, missing Checklist + comment input, missing Board Settings + Analytics). Triage MEDs.
- **Account Settings > Profile:** confirm tier + job title pill render correctly per the dev spec.
- **Account Settings > Members:** confirm Owner / Admin can invite + assign tiers; gate the Admin assign action to Owner only.
- **Account Settings > Sign-in:** confirm the auth flow from email -> sign-in -> session works end to end.

Non-MVP surfaces (caveats, not gates)

- **Templates page:** 8 findings open from R6. Document the known issues; Templates is admin-side and rarely touched after seed. Ship rougher.
- **Ops page:** cross-team capacity view. Only Owner + Admin use it. Can ship after Cohort 1 if needed.
- **Analytics:** nice-to-have. Defer to post-launch unless Cohort 1 needs it for daily ops.
- **Account Settings > Holidays / Time off / Notifications / Preferences / Trash:** 15 findings open from R2. Document caveats; these get used weekly, not daily.
- **Weekly WIP:** confirm Viewer tier can attend (read-only). Beyond that, defer polish.

Documentation for the team

- Write a 1-page "known issues" doc that lists the caveats on non-MVP surfaces. Share with each cohort at brief time.

- Make sure the leadership user-hierarchy guide and the dev spec are both linked in the team handbook.
- Capture a 90-second screen recording showing the most common workflow (open client -> open service -> work the board). Send with each cohort's brief.

Three waves, two feedback windows

The phased rollout has three cohorts. Each cohort gets its own brief, its own launch day, and a feedback window before the next cohort starts. The window is the safety valve: if something breaks for the early cohort, the later ones don't ship until it's fixed.

COHORT 1 · WEEK 1

Operations + Leadership

Tier mix: 1 Owner (Nikko), 1 Admin (Operations Manager).

Size: 2 people. Why first: highest tolerance for rough edges, can directly fix process issues, hold the most context on what the tool is supposed to do.

COHORT 2 · WEEK 2-3

Account Managers

Tier: Manager (scoped to assigned clients).

Size: 7 people. Why second: frontline users; their work produces most of the value but they're also client-facing, so they need a calmer surface than Cohort 1 had.

COHORT 3 · WEEK 4

Operators (everyone else)

Tier: Member (own-card edit, view assigned clients).

Size: 4 people today. Why last: most numerous, most narrowly scoped, can come in once the workflows the earlier cohorts established are stable.

ESCAPE HATCH

If a cohort surfaces a problem the dev can't fix within the feedback window, hold the next cohort. Better to delay than to land a known-broken surface on more users.

Operations + Leadership

Prep (before launch day)

- Confirm the two users are correctly seeded: Nikko as Owner, Ops Manager as Admin. Verify in `Workspace.memberRoles` + their `User.tier` values.
- Send the brief: what works, what's rough, where to log issues. Include the 90-second walkthrough video.
- Set up the daily 10-minute standup for Week 1 (you + Ops Manager). Calendar invite, same time each day.
- Open the support channel (Slack DM or shared doc). Pin a message with how-to-log-an-issue instructions.
- Confirm both users have completed first-time setup (profile pill, job title set, password chosen) on staging the day before launch.

Launch day

- Both users sign in to production for the first time.
- Each user walks one real client end to end: open the client, open a service board, move a card, leave a comment, close the card.
- Log any blocker to the support channel within 30 minutes of hitting it.
- End-of-day check-in: any HIGH-impact issues? Decide carry-on vs hotfix.

Feedback window

- Daily 10-min standup for the full week. Triage issues into hotfix / Cohort-2-blocker / backlog.
- Track issues in a shared list (Notion / Linear / shared doc). Each issue gets: who reported, what surface, what severity, who owns the fix.
- End of Week 1: write a short retrospective. What's working? What's rough? What needs to ship before Cohort 2 starts?

GATE TO COHORT 2

Cohort 2 doesn't start until: (a) all Cohort-1 hotfix items are shipped, (b) the retrospective is written + circulated, (c) Owner explicitly approves moving to the next cohort. No exceptions; the feedback window exists to protect the next wave.

Account Managers

Prep (before launch day)

- Confirm all 7 Account Managers are seeded at Manager tier with their *jobTitleId* set to "Account Manager". Spot-check `Workspace.memberRoles`.
- For each AM, set their *Client.amId* assignments. Each AM should already be the AM of record on their real clients from the legacy data.
- Verify client scoping: sign in as one AM, confirm they see ONLY their assigned clients on the Clients list. If they see everyone's clients, fix scoping before launch.
- Send the Cohort-2 brief: what works (validated by Cohort 1), what's still rough, what changed since the retrospective. Include the same 90-second walkthrough.
- Set up the daily 10-minute standup for Cohort 2 (Nikko + Ops Manager + 1-2 AM representatives). Three days, then weekly thereafter.

Launch day

- All 7 AMs sign in to production on the same day.
- Each AM opens one of their real clients and walks the workflow: review the NEEDS ATTENTION, open the right service board, action the top card.
- Cohort 1 stays online for the launch day to backstop questions. Don't push AMs into the support channel until they hit a real blocker.
- End-of-day check-in: triage any incidents. Anything that breaks the client-scoping promise is a P0; everything else is P1 or below.

Feedback window

- Daily standup for 3 days. After day 3, switch to twice weekly for the remainder of the window.
- Pay special attention to the FROM-PREVIOUS-QA findings: if any of them still bite the AMs day-to-day, escalate to hotfix.
- Confirm the scoping is working: spot-check that no AM sees a client they shouldn't, and every assigned client shows up where expected.
- End of Week 3: short retrospective. Same shape as Cohort 1's.

GATE TO COHORT 3

Cohort 3 doesn't start until: (a) Cohort-2 hotfix items ship, (b) scoping is verified clean (no leaks both ways), (c) at least 5 of 7 AMs report the tool is usable for their daily work. The third condition is the soft gate; it's the human signal that the surface is ready for the rest of the team.

Operators (everyone else)

Prep (before launch day)

- Confirm all 4 Operators are seeded at Member tier with their *jobTitleId* set to "Operator".
- For each Operator, confirm they're on the appropriate *Client.teamIds* arrays (where they support work) and on the appropriate *Card.assigneeIds* (the cards they own).
- Verify Member scoping: sign in as one Operator, confirm they see only assigned clients, and within those, only their own cards are editable + movable.
- Send the Cohort-3 brief. Lighter than Cohort 2's (workflows are now stable). Include any Cohort-2 lessons that affect operators.
- Sunset planning: if there's a legacy tool the operators have been using, decide the cutoff date. Communicate in the brief.

Launch day

- All 4 Operators sign in on the same day.
- Each Operator picks up one assigned card and works it end to end (move from To Do to In Progress, complete subtasks, move to Done).
- Cohort 1 + Cohort 2 stay online to backstop. Operators should hit the support channel if anything blocks.
- End-of-day: confirm no scoping leaks (operators can't see / edit cards they shouldn't).

Feedback window

- Daily standup for 2 days, then weekly thereafter.
- Watch for Member-tier-specific issues: card edit / move scoped to own cards; ability to view (but not edit) cards on assigned clients; ability to comment on any visible card.
- End of Week 4: full-team retrospective. Whole agency on the same tool for the first time.

GATE TO COHORT POST-LAUNCH

Cohort 3 is the full rollout, so the gate is forward-looking: (a) all hotfixes from all three cohorts are shipped, (b) the support channel volume is dropping week over week, (c) the team can answer "is the tool working for you?" with a yes from at least 12 of the 13 users. Then move to Section 08 (Post-launch ops).

After the full team's on, the work shifts from launching to running

Launch ends the moment the third cohort signs in. From there the agency owns the tool and the cadence is operational: triage, iterate, review.

Bug triage cadence

- Set up weekly bug-triage standing meeting (30 minutes, Ops Manager + dev + Nikko). Review the support channel intake from the past week.
- Categorise each issue: critical (ship this week), important (ship this sprint), nice (backlog).
- Maintain the running backlog in the shared issue list started during the cohorts.

Iteration roadmap

- **Month 1 post-launch:** ship the non-MVP-surface findings (Templates polish, Account Settings sub-pages, Analytics polish). Use the existing QA docs as the punch list.
- **Month 2:** ship the LOW backlog from the cohort rollouts (the items that didn't block launch but degrade polish).
- **Month 3:** first quarterly review of access tiers + job titles. Anyone changed roles? Anyone promoted? Sync the data.

Sunset + change management

- Sunset any legacy tool by the agreed cutoff date. Archive (don't delete) the legacy data for at least 90 days in case of restore requests.
- Update the team handbook with how the PM tool fits the agency's operating model.
- Capture lessons learned in a one-pager: what worked in the rollout, what we'd do differently. Keep it for the next tool launch.

DEFINITION OF LAUNCH SUCCESS

All 13 users on the tool. Support channel under 5 issues per week. No HIGH findings open on MVP surfaces. Owner + Admin are using the tier system in anger (assigning roles, inviting members, managing time off). Ops Manager reports weekly status from the tool, not from a spreadsheet. That's launch done.